

O Sacred Head, Now Wounded

- 1 O sacred Head, now wounded,
with grief and shame weighed down;
now scornfully surrounded
with thorns, thine only crown;
O sacred Head, what glory,
what bliss till now was thine!
Yet, though despised and gory,
I joy to call thee mine.
- 2 What thou, my Lord, hast suffered
was all for sinners' gain:
mine, mine was the transgression,
but thine the deadly pain.
Lo, here I fall, my Savior!
'Tis I deserve thy place;
look on me with thy favor,
vouchsafe to me thy grace.
- 3 What language shall I borrow
to thank thee, dearest Friend,
for this, thy dying sorrow,
thy pity without end?
O make me thine forever;
and should I fainting be,
Lord, let me never, never
outlive my love to thee.

Words: Paul Gerhardt, 1656, based on a Medieval Latin poem; tr. James W. Alexander, 1830; alt.

Music: Hans Leo Hassler, 1601; harm. J. S. Bach, 1729

Tune: PASSION CHORALE · 7.6.7.6.D · Scripture: Isaiah 53:5

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